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Review Article

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Working Memory: Theories, Models, and Controversies

- Alan Baddeley[1]
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Abstract

I present an account of the origins and development of the multicomponent approach to working memory, making a distinction between the overall theoretical framework, which has remained relatively stable, and the attempts to build more specific models within this framework. I follow this with a brief discussion of alternative models and their relationship to the framework. I conclude with speculations on further developments and a comment on the value of attempting to apply models and theories beyond the laboratory studies on which they are typically based.

Keyword(s): attention, Autobiography, central executive, episodic buffer, phonological loop, short-term memory, visuo-spatial sketchpad

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